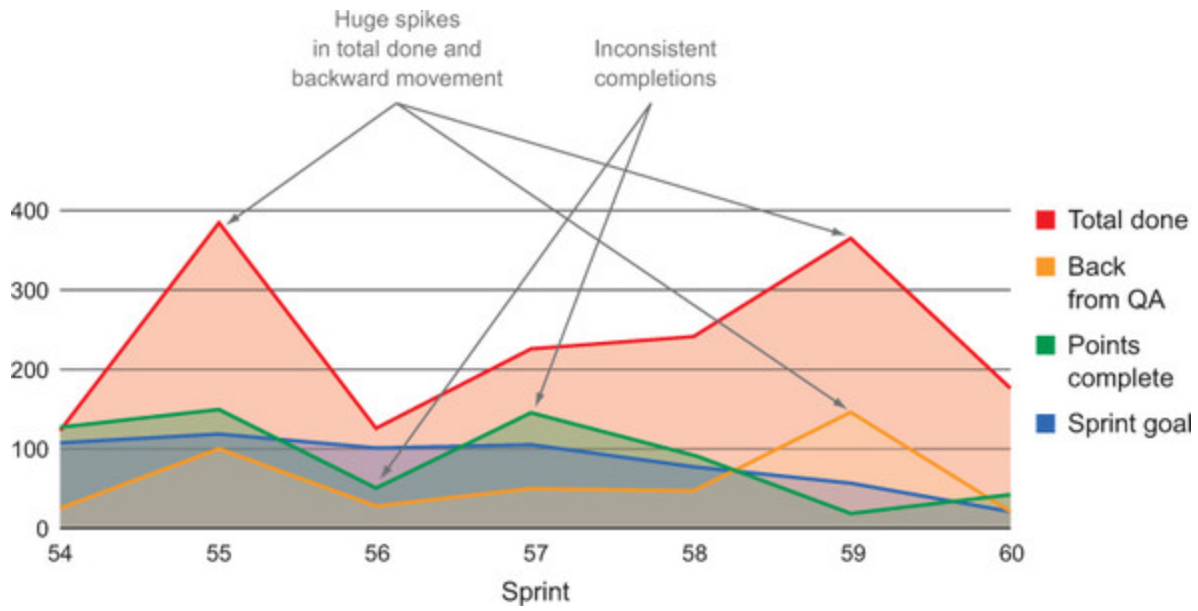
If you don’t have a solid agreement on what it means to complete your tasks and your team doesn’t mark tasks as done in a consistent way, then you won’t be able to trust most of your data. This is because a lot of what you want to know from your PTS centers on how long tasks take to complete versus how long you thought they were going to take. If you don’t have an accurate way to determine when things are complete, it’s hard to know with any certainty how long tasks actually take.

You can tell when your completion criterion is not well defined when you start to see unusual spikes in volume and backward movement, as shown in figure 3.9.

Figure 3.9. Bad trends that you can see when completion criteria are not well defined



This happens for either of the following reasons:

- Tasks that were complete end up back in the work stream.
- Tasks aren’t validated and are sent back to the development team for further work.

Another trend you can see from figure 3.9 is that the completions of the team jump up and down. With unplanned work making its way back to the team, it becomes tough to complete the original commitment. In this case